Three guessed variables do not suffice at ℓ = 8 for this set

These are the results of `research/dreg_closure_guess3_20261023/`; the full text is in `RESULTS.md`. **Class:** stage diagnostic.

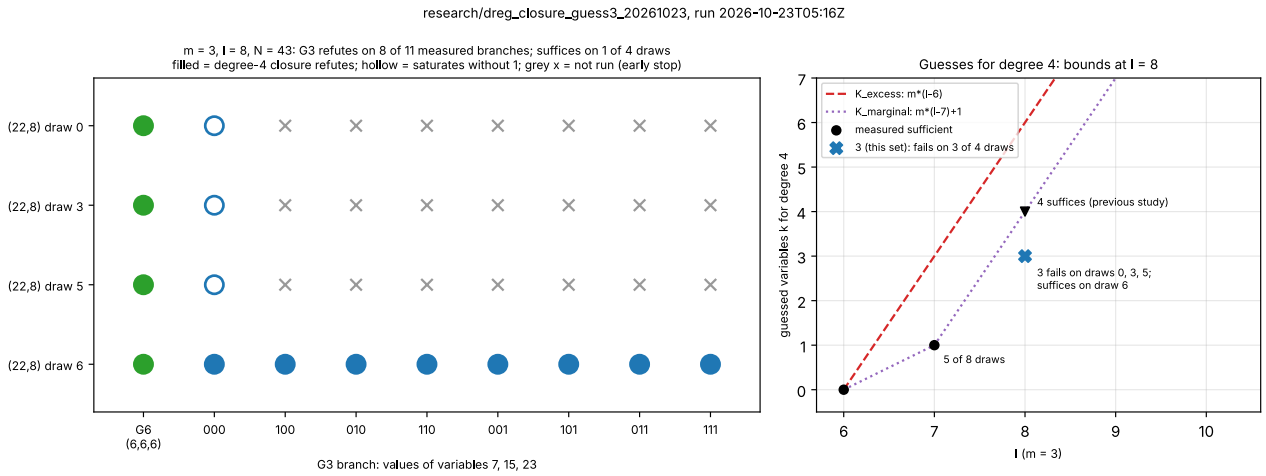

Figure 1: 4 draws × (G6 + 8 G3 branches), run 2026-10-23T05:16Z.

- **Registered verdict: three guesses do not suffice at ℓ = 8 (for this guess set).** 1 draw suffices, 3 do not. On draws 0, 3 and 5 the first branch saturates degree 4 without refuting (the other 7 were not run, by the registered stop rule); on draw 6 all 8 refute. Controls valid: N7 equals the committed record, G6 refutes on 4 of 4.
- **What it says:** three do not suffice for variables 7, 15, 23; four (7, 15, 23, 24) did in the previous study. One cell does not by itself kill the guess-then-degree-4 route or fix a growth law; another three-variable set is unmeasured.
- **ECC2K-130 (derived):** at the priced m = 4, ℓ = 33 cell (N = 394) the ratio `C(394, ≤5) / (2^k · C(394−k, ≤4))` is 78.2, 39.5, 19.95, 10.08, 5.09 for k = 0..4; the hybrid beats degree 5 only if k ≤ 6. No row moves, and no row beats rho.
- **Next:** another three-variable set at ℓ = 8; ℓ = 9, m = 4 at ℓ = 6 and degree 5 past ℓ = 7 need a larger host.